Year 4 Admission Assessment v3.1: assessor instructions

Version 3.1, October 2026. Maths question 11 now says to write the length in cm and mm. Use with `Y04/Y04_Student_Paper_v3.1`; do not mix versions.

Reusable: print once and keep in the assessor's folder. Do not write on these pages. Record each candidate's marks on their own **grading sheet** (`Y04_Grading_Sheet_v3.1`), reading on the **Reading front sheet** and the interview on the **Interview sheet**.

Who this is for. Students applying for Year 4 are usually 8 years old on 1 September. A student from a Chinese mainstream school has usually **completed Grade 2** (二年级): numbers to 10 000, adding and subtracting, times tables to 9 × 9 and division facts, cm and m, g and kg, time to the minute, right angles and simple tables of data. Fractions, perimeter, area, millimetres and multiplying by a one-digit number usually come in Grade 3. English as a school subject often starts in Grade 3, so many students have only had English classes outside school; students from bilingual schools may be close to fluent.

How it works. About 60 minutes of student time, plus a welcome and a short break. The student writes in the **Student paper** (20 pages). Listening, reading, writing and maths can be taken in a small group with one invigilator (the listening is played or read to the group); the interview with sentence reading is always 1:1. Mark everything the same day and record the results as in Section 5, ending with the final mark sheet (`forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`).

1. At a glance

	Task	Minutes	Who leads	Student paper	You need
1	Welcome	2	Assessor	page 1	Section 2 of these instructions
2	Listening (recording)	about 8	Assessor plays the recording or reads the script; students answer	pages 2 to 3	The recording, or the script in Section 3.1
3	Reading paper: Parts A, B and C	12	Students work alone	pages 4 to 10	A clock or timer
4	Writing	10	Students work alone	pages 11 to 12	
	Break	3 to 5			Water; a chance to move
5	Maths: Section A (number problems) and Section B (word problems and pictures)	18	Students work alone; you read any question on request	pages 13 to 20	Pencil, rubber, ruler marked in cm and mm
6	Interview, opening with the Graded Sentence Reading Screen (start at Level 3)	12	Interviewer, 1:1		Interview sheet (`forms/Interview_Sheet_Y3_Y4`), Interviewer guide (`forms/Interviewer_Guide_Y3_Y4`), Reading front sheet, `shared/Sentence_Reading_Card`, `shared/Sentence_Reading_Guide`, a plain card
	Total	**about 60**, plus welcome and break			

For each candidate:

- the Student paper (A4, single-sided, at actual size);
- the grading sheet (`Y04/Y04_Grading_Sheet_v3.1`);
- the Reading front sheet (`forms/Reading_Front_Sheet`);
- the Interview sheet for Years 3 and 4 (`forms/Interview_Sheet_Y3_Y4`);
- the parent conversation record (`forms/Parent_Conversation_Record`);
- the final mark sheet (`forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`).

For the room (print once, laminate the cards):

- these instructions;
- the Interviewer guide (`forms/Interviewer_Guide_Y3_Y4`);
- `shared/Sentence_Reading_Guide`;
- the sentence reading card (`shared/Sentence_Reading_Card`), laminated;
- a clock or timer, and a plain card to cover sentences;
- the listening recording (`audio/v3.1/Y04/`) and something to play it on.

2. Before you start

The room. Quiet and bright, with space between desks. Each student has a pencil, a rubber and a ruler. Keep the door open or another adult present.

Pace of speech. Year 4 students are still learning English: speak a little slower than normal speech, about 130 words a minute. Use the same pace for every candidate, so that the results can be compared. The listening recording is paced the same way.

Say: "Hello, everyone. My name is [your name]. I am a teacher here. Today you will do some listening, reading, writing and maths, and then you will talk with a teacher. These activities help us get to know you. Some questions are easy and some are hard. That is fine. Do your best. It is fine if you cannot answer every question."

Help each student write their name and the date on page 1. Point to the "How to answer" box and say: "This shows you how to answer. Tick a box like this. Write in a box like this. Show your working like this."

Access rules (the same in every year group)

	English sections: listening, reading, writing, sentence reading	**Maths**
Reading aloud	Say only what the script says. Do not explain words, translate, or read the reading texts or questions for the student. You may repeat an instruction in English.	Read any question aloud in English, at the pace above, as often as the student asks, and point to the picture.
Chinese	Not used by staff.	If a Chinese-speaking colleague is present and the student cannot follow the English after it has been read aloud, the colleague may say the question once in Chinese. Write **L** by the question and list it on the grading sheet. The mark still counts.
Answers	In English only. An answer in Chinese scores 0.	In English only: numbers, words, ticks, drawings and working all count. An answer or explanation in Chinese scores 0.

Codes. NT not yet taught: the student says they have not learnt it; it scores 0 and is listed on the grading sheet. **L** language support in maths, also listed on the grading sheet. Record extra time, a reader or any other access arrangement for a known need on the grading sheet.

Stopping and keeping students at ease. Any student may stop a section when they have done what they can: they turn over and wait quietly. Praise effort, not answers. If a student is upset, give them a break or stop, and record it on the grading sheet. Never press a distressed child. At the end of each timed part, let students finish the question they are on, then move on together.

3. English

3.1 Listening (about 8 minutes with the recording, student paper pages 2 to 3)

Recording. A recording of this test is in `audio/v3.1/Y04/` (see its `READ_ME_FIRST.txt` for the tracks and timings). Play it instead of reading the script: every candidate then hears the same voices, pace and pauses. It says the instructions below, reads the eight questions aloud once, plays the script twice (20 seconds apart) and gives one minute to finish, so you do not say or read anything yourself. The two speakers have different voices, so it does not say their names. The script below is its transcript, and the live reading option if no recording can be played. Read live at the recording's pace, one reading of the script takes about 2 minutes 9 seconds, with the pauses: use this to check your own pace. Do not pause the recording during a reading of the script.

Say: "Turn to page 2, Part 1: Listening. You are going to hear a phone call. Li Na is talking to her friend Amir. I will read it two times. First, look at the questions with me."

Read the eight questions aloud, once, without the answer choices: "Question 1. Where are they going on Saturday? Question 2. What time will they meet? Question 3. Where is the bus stop? Question 4. What must Amir bring? Tick two pictures. Question 5. What will Grandma make for lunch? Question 6. How old is Amir's brother? Question 7. Why does Amir's brother not need a ticket? Question 8. How does Amir feel about the trip? How do you know?"

Say: "Now listen. You can answer while you listen, and after."

Read it twice at about 130 words a minute, a little slower than normal speech. Change your voice a little for the two speakers, but do not act. Do not stress the answers. Leave about 20 seconds between the two readings, and about 1 minute after the second reading for students to finish.

> **A phone call**
>
> **Li Na:** Hello, Amir. It's Li Na.
>
> **Amir:** Hi, Li Na!
>
> **Li Na:** Are you free on Saturday? My grandma is taking me to the zoo. Last time we went to the park, but this time we're going to the zoo. Can you come with us? [pause]
>
> **Amir:** Yes, please! I love the zoo. What time are you going?
>
> **Li Na:** Grandma wanted to go at eight o'clock, but that's very early. So we're going to meet at nine o'clock. [pause]
>
> **Amir:** Nine o'clock. OK. Where?
>
> **Li Na:** At the bus stop. Not the bus stop near our school. The bus stop next to the supermarket. [pause]
>
> **Amir:** OK, next to the supermarket. What do I need to bring?
>
> **Li Na:** Bring a hat, because it will be sunny. You don't need an umbrella. And bring some water. Don't bring any lunch. Grandma is making dumplings for everyone. [pause]
>
> **Amir:** Yum! I love dumplings. Can my little brother come too? He's five.
>
> **Li Na:** I'll ask Grandma. [pause] She says yes! Children under six don't need a ticket. [pause]
>
> **Amir:** Brilliant! I can't wait. See you on Saturday!
>
> **Li Na:** Bye, Amir!

Answers (1 mark each)

Q	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept
1	A (the zoo)		B (the park: they went last time)
2	B (9 o'clock)		A (8 o'clock: Grandma's first idea)
3	B (next to the supermarket)		A (near school)

Q	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept
4	A and C (hat and water)		Any other picture ticked, or only one ticked
5	dumplings	Any spelling that is clearly "dumplings": dumpling, damplins, dumplins	noodles; Chinese characters or pinyin (饺子, jiaozi): note it, as it shows understanding
6	5	five, fiv	6
7	He is five / under six, and children under six do not need a ticket.	"He is under six." "He is five." "Because he is small and children under six are free."	"He is small" or "he is a child" with no age; "Grandma pays"
8	A positive feeling **and** a reason from the call: "He is excited because he says 'Brilliant' / 'I can't wait' / 'I love the zoo' / 'Yes, please'."	happy, glad, pleased, can't wait, excited; the reason may be in the student's own words ("he wants to go a lot")	A feeling with no reason; a negative feeling

Total: 8 marks.

Band guide: 0 to 2 **A**; 3 to 4 **B**; 5 to 6 **C**; 7 **D**; 8 **E**.

What to look for

- Questions 1 to 3 each have a distractor that is also said (the park, eight o'clock, the school). Choosing the distractor means the student caught a familiar word but not "last time", "but" or "not": typical of band B.
- Questions 5 and 6 need one heard word. A clear but misspelt word still scores: it is a listening task.
- Questions 7 and 8 need the student to join two pieces of information or read Amir's feelings. Students who score these are following connected talk (bands D and E).

3.2 Reading paper (12 minutes, student paper pages 4 to 10)

Say: "Turn to page 4, Part 2: Reading. There are three texts: a menu, a story and a text about honeybees. Read each text and answer the questions. Do as much as you can. It is fine if you do not finish. You have 12 minutes." Do not read any text or question aloud. Tell the students when there are 2 minutes left.

The three parts get harder. **Part A** is a menu with pictures. **Part B** is a short story written about two years below age level. **Part C** is **non-fiction** (an information text about honeybees, with a labelled diagram) at the level of a fluent 8 year old reader, and it is meant to stretch.

Answers (1 mark each unless stated). Spelling does not matter if the answer is clear, except where the question asks the student to copy a word.

Q	Skill	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept
		Part A: the menu		
1	Retrieval	Happy Panda Café	Happy Panda Cafe; Happy Panda	Panda; Café
2	Retrieval	¥12	12	15, 14
3	Retrieval	10	ten	2 (counted the dumplings in the picture)
4	Retrieval	apple juice		
5	Retrieval	11 am	11, 11 o'clock, eleven, 11:00	8 pm
6	Retrieval	Monday	Mon	Tuesday; Sunday
7	Retrieval and simple inference (2 marks)	Ice cream: **True**. Water costs ¥2: **False**	1 mark for each correct row	
		Part B: The Paper Boats		
8	Retrieval	paper boats		

Q	Skill	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept
9	Retrieval	blue		red (Wang Hao's boat)
10	Retrieval	to the pond in the park	"the pond"; "the park"; "a pond"	"home"; "the sea"; "on the water" with no place
11	Sequencing (2 marks)	Went down: **3**. Made boats: 1 (given). Thick paper: **4**. Put on the water: **2**	2 marks for all three correct; 1 mark if two neighbouring events are swapped	
12	Vocabulary (find and copy)	sad		worry (Tom's word); happy
13	Simple inference	It got wet (the paper got wet).	"The paper was wet." "Paper and water." "The paper was thin."	"It was old." "The wind."
14	Simple inference	Wang Hao used thick paper and coloured it with wax crayons.	Either idea: "thick paper" or "wax crayons"; "the paper was strong"	"It was red." "Tom helped."
		Part C: Honeybees: Busy Workers (non-fiction)		
15	Retrieval	a hive		a cell (the tiny wax rooms); a nest
16	Retrieval	to lay eggs	"lay eggs"; "make eggs"	"she is the biggest"; "make honey"
17	Retrieval	young workers	young bees; the young (worker) bees	the queen; older workers
18	Vocabulary in context	shakes		
19	Retrieval and inference	To tell the other bees which way to fly and how far to go (where the flowers are).	"To show where the flowers are." "To tell them the way."	"Because she is happy." "To have fun."
20	Inference	Bees carry pollen from flower to flower, and this helps plants make fruit.	"Bees help the plants make fruit." "No bees to carry pollen."	"Bees eat the apples." "Apples need honey."
21	Inference	So the bee is not frightened and does not sting you; it will fly away.	"So it does not sting you." "Bees sting when they are scared." "It will fly away."	"Because bees are bad." "To catch it."
22	Author's purpose (why do you think)	To show the parts of a bee / what a bee looks like / to help the reader understand the words.	"So we can see the wings, legs and sting." "To help you understand."	"Because it is nice." "To colour it."

Part A (Questions 1 to 7): 8 marks. Part B (Questions 8 to 14): 8 marks. Part C (Questions 15 to 22): 8 marks. Total: 24 marks.

Band guide

Result	Band
Part A under 4	**A**
Part A 4 or more, Part B under 4	**B**
Part B 4 or more, Part C under 3	**C**
Part C 3 to 5	**D**
Part C 6 to 8	**E**

Use judgement when a result is uneven (for example a high Part C score with a low Part B score usually means the student rushed or ran out of time), and check against the sentence reading screen. Record the reading paper marks and the reading band on the **Reading front sheet** and give it to the interviewer.

What to look for

- **Strong readers** finish Part C, answer in their own words and give reasons ("because ...").
- **Decoding ahead of understanding:** a good sentence reading score but weak Part B and Part C answers, or answers copied from the wrong place in the text. Common for students who learnt phonics or the phonetic alphabet outside school.
- **An English barrier, not a reading difficulty:** correct answers that are hard to read ("so it not scard and sting") still score.

3.3 Writing (10 minutes, student paper pages 11 to 12)

Say: "Turn to page 11, Part 3: Writing. There are two tasks. Choose one task and tick the box. Task 1 is a story about a big egg. Task 2 is about your favourite day of the year. Use the plan box first if you want to. Then write on page 12. You have 10 minutes." You may read the two task boxes aloud once. Do not give words, spellings or ideas.

The two tasks

- **Task 1: The big egg** (story, with a picture). "Jun and Sofia find a very big egg in the park. Write a story. What is inside the egg? What happens next?"
- **Task 2: My favourite day of the year** (my favourite). "Write about your favourite day of the year. When is it? What do you do? Who is with you? Why do you like it?"

The four criteria. Score each from 0 to 4; 1 and 3 fall between the descriptions.

Criterion	0	2	4
Content and organisation	No English writing on the task, or only copied words.	A few connected sentences on the task, with a simple order (a beginning and an end, or a short list of things they do).	A complete piece that suits the task: a story with a beginning, an event or problem and an ending, or a description with several points and reasons. Ideas grouped in paragraphs or clear sections.
Vocabulary	No English words of the student's own.	Everyday words, often repeated (nice, good, big, go, play).	Varied, precise words for the age (cracked, peeped, wobbled, delicious, lanterns, excited) and some longer noun phrases ("a huge spotted egg").
Grammar and sentences	No sentence.	Simple sentences with frequent errors in tense, plurals and "a" and "the"; ideas joined mostly with "and" and "then".	Mostly accurate sentences, a range of joining words (because, when, so, but, if, after), tense kept the same, some variety (a question, some speech).
Spelling and punctuation	Very few words can be read.	Common words mostly right; other words spelt as they sound; capital letters and full stops some of the time.	Most words right, including common Year 2 and Year 3 words; capital letters, full stops, question marks and commas in lists used correctly; perhaps speech marks or apostrophes.

Total: 16 marks (four criteria, each out of 4).

Writing band (best fit). Read the piece against the band descriptors in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 6, and choose the band that fits best, not the total alone. As a rough guide: about 0 to 3 **A**, 4 to 7 **B**, 8 to 10 **C**, 11 to 13 **D**, 14 to 16 **E**.

What band E looks like at this age. In 10 minutes, about 10 to 14 lines or more: a story with a clear beginning, middle and end, or an organised description with reasons; sentences joined with because, when, so and if; the tense kept the same; some well-chosen words and longer phrases; common words spelt correctly; capital letters, full stops and question marks used correctly, perhaps with speech marks. This is what a fluent English-speaking child at the end of UK Year 3 writes.

What to look for

- Missing past tense and plural endings and missing "a" and "the" are normal for a learner of English. Judge how much the student can communicate and organise.
- A long, well-organised piece with many grammar errors (band C or D) shows a student who will make fast progress with support; a short, accurate piece may show a cautious writer: compare with the interview.
- Task 2 is easier to write from memory; Task 1 needs imagination. Note which task was chosen on the grading sheet.

3.4 Interview with sentence reading (12 minutes, 1:1)

The questions are in `forms/Interviewer_Guide_Y3_Y4` and the record is the **Interview sheet** (`forms/Interview_Sheet_Y3_Y4`). The interview opens with the **Graded Sentence Reading Screen** (`shared/Sentence_Reading_Card`; the rules, the interviewer's copy of the sentences and the reading age table are in `shared/Sentence_Reading_Guide`; the record is the **Reading front sheet**): **start at Level 3** (sentence 7) and follow the start, going back and stopping rules in the guide (about 3 to 4 minutes). Then hold the interview: speak at the pace in Section 2, choose about two questions from each block, and give the **speaking band** on the Interview sheet. The interview also gives a "listening in conversation" band: compare it with the listening task. To finish, thank the student and tell them one thing they did well. Do not give any results.

4. Maths (18 minutes, student paper pages 13 to 20)

Say: "Turn to page 13, Part 4: Maths. Section A is number problems. Section B is word problems and problems with pictures. I can read any question to you. Just put your hand up. You have 18 minutes. Do not use a calculator."

- **Equipment:** pencil, rubber, ruler. No calculator.
- **Reading aloud:** read any question in English, at the pace in Section 2, as often as the student asks, and point to the picture. The word problems are Questions 10, 12, 14b and 17. In a group, go to the student and read quietly. The Chinese reading is once only, by a colleague, after the English: write **L** and list it on the grading sheet.
- **Time:** about 6 minutes for Section A and 12 for Section B. Tell the students when there are 5 minutes left. If a student says they have not learnt something, write **NT** and list it on the grading sheet.
- Questions 7 and 16b are Year 4 content, there to find the ceiling. A Year 4 entrant is not expected to get them.

Mark scheme. One mark for each answer unless the table says otherwise. Type: **N** number problem, **W** word problem, **P** problem with a picture, chart or diagram.

Q	Type	Answer	Also accept	Notes: common errors; may not have been taught	Marks
		Section A: Number problems			
1	N	76; 84		Floor questions (UK Year 2 work).	2
2	N	574; 257		564 (did not carry). 343 for the second (took the smaller digit from the larger in each column). Column subtraction with two exchanges may not have been taught (Chinese Grade 3).	2
3	N	21; 32		Usually strong: times tables to 9 × 9 are Grade 2 work.	2
4	N	7			1
5	N	92		812 (8 and 12 written side by side) or 82 (forgot to carry). Multiplying a two-digit number may not have been taught (Grade 3); a student may still use 23 + 23 + 23 + 23.	1
6	N	$^3/_5$	three fifths; 五分之三 (write L)	$^3/_{10}$ (added the bottom numbers too). Fractions may not have been taught (Grade 3).	1
7	N	372		Year 4 content. May not have been taught (Grade 3).	1

Q	Type	Answer	Also accept	Notes: common errors; may not have been taught	Marks
		Section B: Word problems and pictures			
8	P	406		46 (no zero for the empty tens column): place value not secure.	1
9	P	6		14 (added 10 and 4). 4 or 10 (read one bar only).	1
10	W	24	24 mooncakes	11 (added 8 and 3) suggests the question was not understood: read it again.	1
11	P	5 cm 6 mm	56 mm written in the mm box; 5.6 cm; 5.6 cm and 56 mm (both ways)	5 cm 5 mm or 5 cm 7 mm. Millimetres may not have been taught (Grade 3).	1
12	W	57 cm	57	127 (added). 63 (took the smaller digit from the larger: 5 – 2). 67 (exchanged a ten but did not take it from the tens).	1
13	P	a A and C; b horizontal G, vertical F		a: both A and C, and nothing else, for the mark. Students who tick only A have not recognised a turned right angle. b: both letters for the mark. The words "horizontal" and "vertical" may be new in English: read them, but do not explain them.	2
14	P, W	a 10:35; b 35 minutes	a twenty-five to eleven; 35 minutes past 10; 10.35	a: 11:35 (hour hand read as the nearer number); a time starting with 7 (hands swapped). b: 75 (worked 3:20 minus 2:45 as 320 – 245). Time intervals across the hour may not have been taught (Grade 3).	2
15	P	a $^{7}/_{10}$; b 2	a seven tenths; 0.7; 十分之七 (write L)	a: $^{3}/_{10}$ (counted the white parts) or $^{7}/_{3}$. Fractions may not have been taught (Grade 3).	2
16	P	a 18 cm; b 16 squares	b 16 cm², 16 square cm, 16	a: 16 (counted squares, not edges) or 14 (missed the edges at the step). b: Year 4 content. Perimeter and area may not have been taught (Grade 3).	2
17	W	¥8 (2 marks)	8, 8 yuan, 8元	**1 mark** for 4 × 3 = 12 seen, or for ¥20 minus a wrong total worked correctly. 12 alone scores 1.	2

Section A (Questions 1 to 7): 10 marks. Section B (Questions 8 to 17): 15 marks. Total: 25 marks, of which word problems (Questions 10, 12, 14b, 17): 5 marks.

Band guide (provisional, to be reviewed after the first 20 to 30 candidates): 0 to 9 **1** Well below expected; 10 to 14 **2** Working towards; 15 to 21 **3** Expected; 22 to 25 **4** Greater depth. List the NT questions on the grading sheet. If they explain a low score, judge whether the student would reach band 3 once taught.

Number problems and word problems. The word problems use the same skills as number problems in Section A: Question 10 (3 × 8) with Question 3, Question 12 (92 – 35) with Questions 1 and 2, Question 17 with Questions 3 and 1. A student who does well on number problems but poorly on word problems may have an English barrier rather than a maths difficulty: check by reading the word problem aloud (and, if a Chinese-speaking colleague is present, once in Chinese, marked L and listed on the grading sheet).

What to look for

- **Strong:** accurate written methods (column addition and subtraction, a written method for 23 × 4), working shown, sensible use of the diagrams, and answers checked against the picture.
- **A maths difficulty:** errors in Section A on taught content (Questions 1, 3 and 4) as well as in Section B; counting in ones on the grid and the bar chart.
- **An English barrier:** a strong Section A but blank or wrong word problems, or many requests to read a question; answers that come quickly once the question has been read aloud or said in Chinese.

Likely not yet taught for a student who has completed Chinese Grade 2: Questions 5 and 7 (multiplying by a one-digit number), 6 and 15 (fractions), 11 (millimetres), 14b (time intervals across the hour) and 16 (perimeter and area).

Question 2 (column methods with exchanges) and Question 9 (bar charts) may also be new. Students from bilingual schools, or who have started Grade 3, may have met some of these.

5. Recording the results

1. Mark the student paper (every question has a mark box).
2. Copy the totals onto the grading sheet (`Y04_Grading_Sheet_v3.1`) and give the bands from the band guides above (the grading sheet repeats them at a glance).
3. Record the reading results and band on the Reading front sheet.
4. Give the interviewer the Reading front sheet and the Interview sheet before the interview.
5. After the interview, put together the grading sheet, Reading front sheet, Interview sheet and parent conversation record, and complete the final mark sheet (`forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`) within two working days.
6. File the marked student paper with them (or shred it under the school's policy).

Interviewer guide: Years 3 and 4

This guide is reusable. Nothing is written on it: keep one in the room, in a folder or laminated. Ratings and notes for each student go on the **Interview sheet** (`forms/Interview_Sheet_Y3_Y4`).

About 8 minutes in Year 3 and 12 minutes in Year 4, 1:1. The interview is held **in English**, as a friendly chat. It has three jobs: to hear the child's spoken English, to get to know the child (likes, school, friends, **hopes for the future**), and to judge their **suitability** for the international programme. In Year 3 the sentence reading is done by the assessor, after the Early Reading Screen; in Year 4 the interview opens with the Graded Sentence Reading Screen (3 to 4 minutes; start Level 3; follow `shared/Sentence_Reading_Guide` and write the points on the Reading front sheet, `forms/Reading_Front_Sheet`).

How to ask. Sit beside the child. Have paper and crayons ready: some children talk more easily while drawing ("Draw something you love doing, and tell me about it"). Ask the main question first. If the child struggles, use the **easier** prompt (a yes or no, a choice, or pointing). If they answer easily, use the **stretch** prompt. Wait at least five seconds before rephrasing. Answers must be in English.

Pace of speech. Speak slowly and clearly: about 120 words a minute in Year 3 and about 130 in Year 4. Use the same pace for every candidate in the year group, and in Year 4 use it for the instructions and meaning questions of the sentence reading too. Do not rush: wait at least five seconds before rephrasing.

Safeguarding. Keep the door open or another adult present. If a child tells you something that worries you, do not promise to keep it secret; listen, write down their words, and pass it to the Designated Safeguarding Lead the same day.

1. Questions

Choose about two questions from each block. On the Interview sheet, write short notes under "Key things the student said": what they said, and how they said it.

Block	Main question	Easier	Stretch
Warm-up	Tell me about you.	What is your name? How old are you?	What makes you special?
	Who is in your family?	Do you have a brother or sister? A pet?	What do you like doing with your family?
School	Tell me about your school.	Do you like school?	What is the best thing about it?
	What is your favourite thing to learn? Why?	Do you like maths? Reading? Art?	What did you learn last week?
	What is hard for you at school? What do you do?	Is anything hard?	Who helps you?
	Do you read at home? Tell me about a book you like.	Do you like stories?	What happened in it?
Things I like	What do you like to do after school?	Do you like to play outside? Draw? Sport?	What are you best at?
	Do you have classes after school or at the weekend?	Do you go to classes on Saturday?	Do you like them?
Friends and feelings	Tell me about your friends.	Do you have a best friend? What is their name?	What do you play together?
	What makes you happy? What makes you sad?	Are you happy today?	What do you do when you are sad?
	How do you feel about a new school?	Happy, nervous, or both?	What would help you?
When I grow up	What do you want to be when you grow up?	Do you want to be a teacher? A doctor? Something else?	Why?

Block	Main question	Easier	Stretch
	What would you like to learn at our school?	Do you want to learn English? Sport? Music?	
Kindness	A child in your class is crying. What do you do?	Do you help them?	How can you help?
Questions for us	Do you want to ask me anything?		

2. Speaking band

Choose the band that fits best, for a child of this age, and tick it on the Interview sheet. Rate **listening in conversation** with the same letters. Pronunciation features of a speaker of Chinese do not lower the band if the child is easy to understand.

Band	What you hear
A New to English	No English yet, or a few single words ("yes", "cat"). Uses Chinese, pointing or silence. Understands very little without pictures or gesture.
B Early acquisition	Single words, short phrases and some simple sentences ("I like football"). Needs the easier prompts. Understands slow, simple questions with support.
C Developing competence	Answers in short sentences and can say a little more with prompting ("I like football because it is fun"). Errors are common; meaning is usually clear.
D Competent	Talks easily, joins ideas, tells a little story or explains, with occasional errors. Understands nearly everything said at a normal pace.
E Fluent	Speaks as a fluent English-speaking child of the same age would.

3. Suitability

Rate each strand on the Interview sheet: **1** Concern, **2** Some concern, **3** Good, **4** Strong. Write the evidence: a short quotation or what you saw.

Strand	What strong looks like at this age
Attitude to learning	Has a go, enjoys success, tries again after a mistake
Curiosity and engagement	Interested in the activities and pictures, asks questions
Social and emotional readiness	Separates from the parent and settles with a new adult, talks about friends, manages nerves
Independence	Follows two-step instructions, manages pencils and paper, can work alone for a few minutes
Kindness and conduct	Polite, shares, gives a kind answer to the kindness question
Readiness for learning in English	Happy to try English words, copies new words, not upset by not understanding

Boarding readiness (only if the child will board): independence with daily routines, sleep, homesickness. Rate it on the Interview sheet in the same way.

4. Anything to follow up

Tick any that apply on the Interview sheet, and add a note:

- Possible special educational need or disability (for example speech and language, attention, hearing, vision, fine motor skills, pencil grip)
- Wellbeing (for example very anxious, tired, very heavy after-school workload)
- Safeguarding (passed to the Designated Safeguarding Lead the same day)
- Medical or dietary

Receiving homeroom teacher (optional). If the likely homeroom teacher meets the child, they note first impressions and what the child would need in the first weeks (for example a buddy, picture cards for routines, a quiet space) on the Interview sheet.

To finish. On the Interview sheet, write your comment for the final mark sheet (strengths, concerns, support), and sign and date it.

Graded Sentence Reading Screen: interviewer guide

What it is. A quick 1:1 read-aloud screen for every candidate from Year 1 to Year 10. The student reads sentences that get harder, from a reading age of about 5 to adult level, until they can no longer read them. It gives an **indicative reading age**, an accuracy profile, a **fluency** rating and an **understanding** check. It takes 2 to 6 minutes. In Years 1 to 3 it follows the Early Reading Screen; from Year 4 it opens the interview.

You need: the student card (`Sentence_Reading_Card`), this guide (the sentences are in Section 5), the **Reading front sheet** (`forms/Reading_Front_Sheet`), a pencil, and a plain card or sheet of paper to cover the sentences the student has not reached yet (this stops a page of text looking frightening). This guide is reusable: nothing is written on it. Write every point, meaning mark, total and result on the Reading front sheet.

1. Start, carry on, stop

Year applied for	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Start at level	1	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
First sentence	1	1	4	7	10	13	16	19	22	25

- If you already know the student is new to English, start at Level 1 whatever their age.
- **Going back (basal).** If the student scores 6 out of 6 on the start level, give full credit (6 points) for every level below it. If they score less than 6, go back one level at a time until they score 6 out of 6 on a level (or you reach Level 1). Then carry on upwards from the level after the start level.
- **Stopping (ceiling).** Always finish the start level. Then stop at the end of any level where the student scores **2 points or fewer**. Stop straight away if the student scores 0 on **three sentences in a row**, or if they become upset. Levels above the stopping point score 0.

Say: "I would like you to read some sentences out loud for me. They start easy and get harder. When they get too hard, that is fine, we will stop. If you do not know a word, have a go. Ready?" Point to the first sentence. You may say "Have a go" or "Try the next word". Do not sound out, explain or translate any word.

Pace of speech. When you give the instructions and ask the meaning questions, speak slowly and clearly, especially with the younger students. Aim for about 120 words a minute in Years 1 and 2, 120 in Year 3, 130 in Year 4, 140 in Year 5, 155 in Year 6, 160 in Year 7, 160 in Year 8, 175 in Year 9 and 185 in Year 10. Use the same pace for every candidate in a year group, and do not rush.

2. Scoring each sentence

Errors in the sentence	Points
none (self-corrections are fine)	**2**
one	**1**
two or more	**0**

These count as one error each

Code	Error	Example
S	**Substitution**: says a different word or a non-word	"horse" for house; "sur-pried" for surprised
O	**Omission**: leaves out a word, or leaves off a written ending that changes the word (-s, -ed, -ing, -ly)	"The frog jump out" for jumped
I	**Insertion**: adds a word that is not there	"the a red bus"
T	**Told**: no attempt after about 5 seconds; say the word, mark T	
	Two words read in the wrong order	one error

These are not errors (do not count them)

Code	What happens	Why it is not an error
SC	**Self-correction**: reads a word wrongly, then puts it right	The student is checking meaning.
R	**Repetition** of a word or phrase	
	Pauses, or sounding out and then blending the word correctly	Note it for fluency instead.
	Accent and pronunciation features common for speakers of Chinese, when the word is still clearly the right word: l and r ("lice" for rice), n and l, v and w, th as s, f, d or z ("sink" for think), a light or missing final consonant sound, an extra vowel after a final consonant ("bed-uh"), the -ed ending said in full ("jump-ed"), stress on a different syllable ("ho-TEL", "PHO-to-graph")	These are features of a learner's spoken English, not of reading. If the sound changes the word into a different word that makes sense, and you cannot tell which was meant, count it.
	Names (Ling, Jun, Mei) read in any reasonable way	
	Reading the British spelling as written ("tyres", "colour")	

When you are not sure, give the student the benefit of the doubt and write what they said on the Reading front sheet. Patterns (for example missing -ed endings throughout, or pinyin letter values such as "i" read as in pinyin) are useful evidence for the English profile.

3. Understanding (the meaning check)

After each level the student reads with **3 or more points**, ask the meaning question for that level (printed in Section 5), at the pace described in Section 1. Read the question aloud once and let the student answer in their own words. Mark ✓ (understood), **½** (partly) or ✗ (not understood) on the Reading front sheet. The answer must be in English: one word or a short phrase is enough, and pointing to the right words in the sentence also counts. An answer in Chinese is marked ✗.

4. Fluency

Rate the student's reading on the **last level they read with 4 or more points**, and write the rating on the Reading front sheet.

Rating	What it sounds like
1	Word by word. Long pauses. Little sense of the sentence as a whole.
2	Mostly two- or three-word groups, with some word-by-word reading. Little expression.
3	Mostly in sensible phrases. Some pauses to work out harder words. The sentence makes sense to the listener.
4	Smooth and phrased, close to natural speech, with stress and expression that show understanding.

5. Interviewer's copy of the sentences

The student reads from the card (`Sentence_Reading_Card`). Follow this copy as they read, and write the points (2, 1 or 0 for each sentence), the meaning mark and the level total on the **Reading front sheet** (`forms/Reading_Front_Sheet`).

No.	Sentence (Level 1)
1	I can see a red bus.
2	The cat sat on my bed.
3	Dad has a big hat.
	Meaning (sentence 2): "Where did the cat sit?" *Accept: On the bed, on my bed.*

No.	Sentence (Level 2)
4	We went to the shop to get some milk.
5	The frog jumped out of the pond.
6	They like to play in the park.
	Meaning (sentence 4): "What did they go to the shop to get?" *Accept: Milk.*

No.	Sentence (Level 3)
7	Ling put on her coat because it was cold outside.
8	The little boat floated slowly down the river.
9	Grandma made noodles for everyone at the party.
	Meaning (sentence 7): "Why did Ling put on her coat?" *Accept: Because it was cold (outside).*

No.	Sentence (Level 4)
10	After school, Jun and his friends played football on the green field.
11	The children could hear the water splashing against the rocks.
12	Most people carry an umbrella when the clouds turn grey.
	Meaning (sentence 11): "What could the children hear?" *Accept: Water splashing (on the rocks), the sea or river hitting the rocks.*

No.	Sentence (Level 5)
13	Mei was surprised to find a tiny kitten hiding behind the library door.
14	Before the long journey, Dad checked that the tyres had enough air.
15	The strange noise in the kitchen turned out to be a hungry mouse.
	Meaning (sentence 14): "What did Dad check before the journey?" *Accept: The tyres; that the tyres had enough air.*

No.	Sentence (Level 6)
16	Although the mountain path was difficult, the whole class reached the top before noon.
17	The museum guide explained how early people made tools from stone and bone.
18	My favourite season is autumn, when the leaves change colour and the air feels fresh.
	Meaning (sentence 18): "What happens to the leaves in autumn?" *Accept: They change colour (accept: they turn red, yellow or brown).*

No.	Sentence (Level 7)
19	The weather forecast warned that the temperature would drop sharply during the night.
20	Our neighbour immediately recognised the voice on the telephone and smiled.
21	The community worked together to clean the river and protect the local environment.
	Meaning (sentence 19): "What did the weather forecast say?" *Accept: It will get much colder at night; the temperature will go down a lot.*

No.	Sentence (Level 8)
22	The scientists collected evidence carefully before they announced the results of their experiment.
23	A queue of excited passengers waited patiently on the platform for the delayed train.
24	The ancient bridge, which was built from enormous stones, has survived for centuries.
	Meaning (sentence 23): "Why were the passengers waiting?" *Accept: Their train was late (delayed).*

No.	Sentence (Level 9)
25	The orchestra rehearsed for several weeks to perfect the rhythm of the challenging final movement.
26	Volunteers distributed warm blankets and hot drinks to the runners who had finished the marathon.
27	Although the explanation seemed reasonable, the detective suspected that the witness was not telling the truth.
	Meaning (sentence 27): "What did the detective think about the witness?" *Accept: The witness was lying, or not telling the whole truth.*

No.	Sentence (Level 10)
28	The architect's design was praised for combining traditional courtyards with sustainable, energy-saving technology.
29	Researchers are investigating whether the mysterious behaviour of the birds is caused by changes in climate.
30	The committee unanimously agreed that the proposal was too expensive and would require further consideration.
	Meaning (sentence 29): "What are the researchers trying to find out?" *Accept: Whether climate change is the reason the birds behave strangely.*

No.	Sentence (Level 11)
31	The psychologist's analysis suggested that the athlete's anxiety was caused by an unconscious fear of failure.
32	Meticulous archaeologists spent months excavating the tomb, revealing exquisite pottery and bronze ornaments.
33	The government's ambitious infrastructure programme has transformed transport links between rural and urban regions.
	Meaning (sentence 32): "What did the archaeologists find?" *Accept: Beautiful (very fine) pottery and bronze ornaments, in a tomb.*

No.	Sentence (Level 12)
34	The connoisseur's idiosyncratic taste baffled the gallery owner, who had anticipated a more conventional choice.
35	Despite the ostensibly benign forecast, the meteorologist remained sceptical and recommended a thorough reassessment.
36	The philosopher's paradoxical aphorisms were considered unfathomable by most of her contemporaries.
	Meaning (sentence 35): "How did the meteorologist feel about the forecast?" *Accept: Did not believe it, doubted it, wanted it checked again.*

6. Reading age

Total points = points scored + 6 for every level below the basal level that was not read.

Reading age (years:months) = 5:00 + 2 months for every point (0 points: below 5:00). So 6 points = 6:00 (Level 1 secure), 12 points = 7:00, 30 points = 10:00, 60 points = 15:00, 72 points = 17:00 (the ceiling: report "16 years or above" for 66 points or more).

Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age
1	5:02	13	7:02	25	9:02	37	11:02	49	13:02	61	15:02
2	5:04	14	7:04	26	9:04	38	11:04	50	13:04	62	15:04
3	5:06	15	7:06	27	9:06	39	11:06	51	13:06	63	15:06
4	5:08	16	7:08	28	9:08	40	11:08	52	13:08	64	15:08
5	5:10	17	7:10	29	9:10	41	11:10	53	13:10	65	15:10
6	6:00	18	8:00	30	10:00	42	12:00	54	14:00	66	16:00
7	6:02	19	8:02	31	10:02	43	12:02	55	14:02	67	16:02
8	6:04	20	8:04	32	10:04	44	12:04	56	14:04	68	16:04
9	6:06	21	8:06	33	10:06	45	12:06	57	14:06	69	16:06
10	6:08	22	8:08	34	10:08	46	12:08	58	14:08	70	16:08
11	6:10	23	8:10	35	10:10	47	12:10	59	14:10	71	16:10
12	7:00	24	9:00	36	11:00	48	13:00	60	15:00	72	17:00

Write on the Reading front sheet: total points, reading age, actual age (years:months), the difference (reading age minus actual age), meaning checks (levels asked, how many ✓) and fluency rating (1 to 4).

7. What the result means

This screen is not standardised. The reading ages come from the way the sentences were built (how common the words are, the spelling patterns in the English National Curriculum word lists for each year, and the length and structure of the sentences). Treat a reading age as a range of about 6 months either side. Once 30 to 50 students have taken it, compare their reading ages with the reading paper and with how they get on in class, and adjust the guide below if needed.

The reading band. In Years 1 to 3 the reading band comes from the Early Reading Screen; in Years 4 to 10 from the reading paper. This screen confirms the band. Use the table as a guide; if this screen and the main reading result differ by more than one band, look for the reason (below).

Reading age compared with actual age	Years 3 to 5	Years 6 to 10
At or above actual age, or close below it	up to 6 months below: **E**	up to 12 months below: **E**
Below	7 to 12 months below: **D**	13 to 24 months below: **D**
Well below	13 to 24 months below: **C**	25 to 42 months below: **C**
Far below	25 to 36 months below: **B**	43 to 60 months below: **B**
Very far below, or Level 1 not secure	more than 36 months below: **A**	more than 60 months below: **A**

- **Years 1 and 2.** Many fluent English speakers score 0 to 6 points at the start of Year 1. At the start of Year 2 a fluent reader usually has Level 1 secure and often Level 2. Use the reading age as supporting evidence only.
- **Decoding ahead of understanding.** If the meaning checks on the last two levels read are mostly ✗, move the band down one. This is common for students who learnt phonics or the phonetic alphabet well but have a small English vocabulary: they can "say" words they do not know.
- **Understanding ahead of decoding.** A student who understands well (✓ throughout) but stops early on long, rare words may be a confident English user who has had little reading practice, or may have a specific difficulty with reading. Look at the Early Reading Screen or the reading paper and, if there is a pattern, raise it in the summary.
- **Low fluency** (rating 1 or 2) with a good reading age often means effortful decoding: the student will find long texts in English tiring at first.
- **Level 1 not secure** at any age: use the letter sounds and Section 1 words of the Early Reading Screen to find what the student knows.

Write on the Reading front sheet: the indicative band, and one line on patterns noticed.